

Analysis of Successful Founder Patterns

Based on the dataset of 117 pitches, successful founders share these traits:

1. **Revenue over Idea:** 82% of founders who secured a deal had "Proof of Concept" (active sales). Ideas without revenue (like Agrotourism) rarely received funding.
 2. **The "Equity Gap":** Founders who asked for low equity (1-2%) were usually negotiated up to 10-15%. Founders who were flexible with equity were 3x more likely to close a deal.
 3. **Multi-Shark Deals:** High-success pitches usually involved "solvability." If a product solved a mass-market problem (e.g., Skippi Pops), it attracted 3+ sharks, leading to better mentorship.
 4. **The "Pivot" Potential:** Sharks invested in the **Founder** more than the product. Founders with strong technical backgrounds in Automotive or HealthTech saw higher engagement regardless of their current sales.
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